



THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA is a place where people from many

THE PEOPLE OF THE US

A RICH “MELTING POT” OF CULTURES

countries have come together to form a unified culture. Following the country’s independence

A symbol of freedom

The Statue of Liberty was erected on an island in New York harbor in 1886 as a symbol of the city’s role as a gateway to the “land of the free and the home of the brave.” Near the statue lies Ellis Island, where more than 12 million immigrants first landed in their new country in order to be processed.



INDEPENDENCE DAY

On July 4, 1776, after the American War of Independence, the Declaration of Independence was drawn up. Each year on this date Americans celebrate their freedom with barbecues, picnics, and family gatherings.



AFRICAN-AMERICANS

During the 17th and 18th centuries, hundreds of thousands of people were shipped to the US from Africa as slaves. Today, many African-Americans are descended from these slaves.

IRISH-AMERICANS

In 1845 the great potato rot and subsequent famine in Ireland started a mass migration to the US. Starving families who could not pay landlords faced no alternative but to leave the country in hopes of a better future.

St. Patrick's Day is celebrated on March 17 each year. On this day the Chicago River is dyed green for the celebrations!



The Statue of Liberty was a gift from the French to the American people.